

Meera Pillai

Executive Chef

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Award-winning Executive Chef with 12 years of culinary leadership experience in fine dining and upscale casual restaurants. Expertise in menu development, kitchen operations, and team leadership in high-volume environments.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Executive Chef — Taj Malabar Resort & Spa

2018 - Present

- Lead a kitchen team of 18, overseeing menu development, food cost management, and quality control.
- Redesigned the seasonal menu, increasing average check size by 18% and earning a regional 'Best New Menu' award.
- Reduced food cost percentage from 34% to 28% through improved inventory and vendor negotiation.
- Train and develop sous chefs, 3 of whom have been promoted to executive chef roles elsewhere.

Sous Chef — The Leela Kovalam

2014 - 2018

- Managed daily kitchen operations for a 150-seat fine dining restaurant.
- Developed and trained staff on new dish preparations for seasonal menu rotations.

EDUCATION

Diploma in Culinary Arts — Institute of Hotel Management, Mumbai

2010 - 2012

SKILLS

Menu Development • Food Cost Management • Kitchen Operations • Team Leadership • Vendor Negotiation

CERTIFICATIONS

- FSSAI Food Safety Supervisor Certification
- Certified Executive Chef - Indian Federation of Culinary Associations